

r/antiai

So I always see them try to say AI doesn't use much water but...

Posted by u/Virtually_Harmless • 0 points • 14 comments

<https://www.wdbj7.com/2026/02/04/virginia-lawmakers-look-address-data-center-water-use/>

Kinda seems to me that if that were true this wouldn't be necessary.

Comments

u/jazzhandler • 1 points • 2026-02-10 22:46 UTC

Legislators legislating isn't proof of anything, though. Which US state just outlawed chemtrails?

u/Virtually_Harmless • 1 points • 2026-02-10 23:07 UTC

are you just ignoring the overabundance of data centers in places that aren't appropriate for them?

u/jazzhandler • 1 points • 2026-02-10 23:10 UTC

Not in the slightest, I think it's ridiculous. In fact, using the word ridiculous makes me feel like I should grab a thesaurus because that doesn't even begin to cut it.

I was just pointing out that a legislature's priorities are often about as accurate as an LLM's advice.

u/Virtually_Harmless • 2 points • 2026-02-10 23:12 UTC

Yeah, there certainly is that. Legislators get "captured" by the industries they are intended to regulate. Maybe it easy to do whatever you want to do with no regard for the wellbeing of the planet or society.

Alas

u/khisanthmagus • 1 points • 2026-02-10 17:12 UTC

[<https://www.eesi.org/articles/view/data-centers-and-water-consumption>]
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The EESI study shows that large data centers can use up to 5 million gallons per day, the equivalent of a town of 10-50k. Given that they usually try and get these datacenters built in small towns, there is no way that the town's water systems can handle that kind of increased demand. There is also an issue that due to climate change some aquifers are no longer gaining water as fast as the datacenters can drain them, which is resulting in water shortages in areas.

u/supergnaw • 1 points • 2026-02-10 21:00 UTC

> A data center's water footprint is calculated as the sum of three categories: on-site water usage, water use by power plant facilities that supply power to data centers, and water consumption during the manufacturing process of processor chips.

Okay but I just want to know how much they use please without these other numbers lol.

u/Elegant-Pie6486 • 1 points • 2026-02-10 11:04 UTC

Honestly seems weird that if you were somewhere with water stress you wouldn't already have requirements on water efficiency and usage.

u/Virtually_Harmless • 1 points • 2026-02-10 13:44 UTC

Yeah well.... you should tell that to the people who decided to build the data centers where they did.

u/Elegant-Pie6486 • 1 points • 2026-02-10 13:46 UTC

I think it would be better to tell it to the local legislative, new commercial buildings should disclose what energy, water, waste, traffic, etc they're likely to require and if it would be a significant impact offset it in some way.

That's pretty standard stuff in many countries.

u/Virtually_Harmless • 1 points • 2026-02-10 13:50 UTC

You know as well as I do that it's not only up to the legislators when the legislation has been captured by the industries that are meant to regulate them.

u/Elegant-Pie6486 • 1 points • 2026-02-10 13:53 UTC

If your government is captured by corporate interests then data centres are the least of your worries, imagine what would happen to food safety and healthcare and workers rights if that happened.

u/khisanthmagus • 1 points • 2026-02-10 17:10 UTC

It is easy for companies to find small towns with corrupt leaders who have enough influence to get something like a data center approved if there is enough of a bribe. This is an article I read a while ago about a town in Oregon who are being killed because Amazon built a datacenter there that their water system couldn't handle.

[<https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/culture-features/data-center-water-pollution-amazon-oregon-1235466613/>]
(<https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/culture-features/data-center-water-pollution-amazon-oregon-1235466613/>)

The EESI published a report stating

that large data centers can consume up to 5 million gallons per day, as much as a town of 10-50k. For a small town that has less than that population there is absolutely no way their water systems can handle that kind of demand, but there is never a requirement that the company installing the data center pay for the infrastructure improvements that would be needed.

u/Elegant-Pie6486 • 1 points • 2026-02-10 17:23 UTC

Frankly the issue predates the data centre but if that got some people to do something about the water quality that's a win.

Yes standards shouldn't be set at the town level for that reason.

u/Wide_Pop_5973 • 1 points • 2026-02-10 06:51 UTC

facts